

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8
 ♥ Q J 9 4 2
 ♦ 9 5
 ♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9 5 3

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 6 4

West

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠5

North

1NT

East

Pass

South

3NT

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠5, dummy plays the ♠2 and West the ♠Q.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 8

Before worrying about where that one winner is going to come from you need to decide what to do with the opening lead. A good guideline is to hold up unless you fear a switch. Here, with all other suits well protected you would welcome a switch, so you let West win the ♠Q. West then plays the ♠8. Do you hold up again?

It probably doesn't matter, but since you cannot possibly win more than 10 tricks you might just as well hold up again. East wins the ♠J then plays the ♠3. West discards a ♥ on the third ♠.

OK, now it is time to figure out where that extra trick is coming from. Not much figuring is needed, it must come from the ♦ suit. Since you are missing 5 cards including the Queen, the odds favor a finesse over playing for the drop. And, since you have the option of finessing either defender are you going to finesse into the one who can set you or into the safe one?

You play the ♦K from your hand, then a small ♦, and East plays low.

Silly question. Of course you finesse into the safe hand: dummy's ♦10 wins the trick - and the game - and the overtrick.

Actually the odds slightly favored West holding the ♦Q because West started with only 2 ♠s compared to East's 5 ♠s. Therefore West had 11 spaces which could hold the ♦Q whereas East only had 8 spaces.

But in a situation like this you don't play odds. By finessing East you guaranteed making the contract even if the finesse lost because West had no more ♠s. Even a losing ♦ finesse would have established the one trick you needed.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 9
♥ 6 5
♦ A K Q
♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2
♥ K 9 7 4 2
♦ 8 5 3
♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3
♥ A 8
♦ J 10 6
♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ 9 7 4 2
♣ K 8 7 2

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♣	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♦	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			

6♠ by East

Lead: ♥Q

East is to play 6♠ after West's Stayman bid. South leads the ♥Q, dummy plays the ♥5 and North the ♥2.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=1 Total = 2

This looks like a very simple plan. Since the hands have mirrored distribution there will be no discards anywhere. That means the ♣K **MUST** be in South's hand or you will go down. But is that all there is to it?

If South has ♣ K x or ♣ K x x then yes, that's all there is to it. But if he has ♣ K x x x then you won't have enough entries to your hand unless you take the first ♣ finesse **BEFORE** you start on trumps.

You have won the ♥A.

South plays low.

The ♥A, then immediately a ♣ to dummy's ♣J, which holds the trick. Then pull trumps, (it takes 4 rounds), ending in your hand.

South plays low again.

Your ♣10, putting on the ♣5 from dummy when South plays low again. This lets you stay in your hand to play another ♣ to the ♣Q, picking up all four ♣ tricks and the slam.

This Deal took a lot of care and attention. As you can see you had to take one ♣ finesse before you drew trumps because you were in your hand right then and you could only get back one more time.

But also you had to play to one of dummy's honors first so you could retain that ♣5 for letting you stay in your hand to make the third finesse. Bridge is great.

Board 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 8

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q J 9
♥ 6 5
♦ A K Q
♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2
♥ K 9 7 4 2
♦ 8 5 3
♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3
♥ A 8
♦ J 10 6
♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6
♥ Q J 10 3
♦ 9 7 4 2
♣ K 8 7 2

Board 9

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 6 4

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 6 4

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 17

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 6 4

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 21

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 6 4

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 25

North Deals

E-W Vul

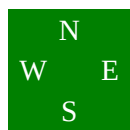
♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 6 4

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

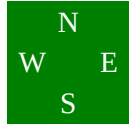
♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 27

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

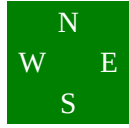
♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 31

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 6 4

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 33

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6
♥ K 7 5
♦ K J 6 3
♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3
♥ 10 6
♦ Q 8 4
♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2
♥ A 8 3
♦ A 10 7 2
♣ K 6 4

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

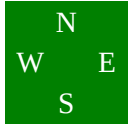
♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2

Board 35

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 8
♥ Q J 9 4 2
♦ 9 5
♣ J 9 7 2

♠ A 7 6

♥ K 7 5

♦ K J 6 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ K J 9 5 3

♥ 10 6

♦ Q 8 4

♣ 10 8 5

♠ 10 4 2

♥ A 8 3

♦ A 10 7 2

♣ K 6 4

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q J 9

♥ 6 5

♦ A K Q

♣ A Q J 5

♠ 10 8 4 2

♥ K 9 7 4 2

♦ 8 5 3

♣ 6



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ A 8

♦ J 10 6

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ 9 7 4 2

♣ K 8 7 2